A Package for Mrs. Jewls

By Louis Sachar

(Louis enters, shaking his head and frowning at the mess he sees all over the playground)

NARRATOR: The school yard was a mess. There were pencils and pieces of paper everywhere.

LOUIS: *(muttering aloud)* How'd all this junk get here? Well, I'm not going to pick it up!

NARRATOR: It wasn't his job to pick up garbage. He was just supposed to pass out the balls during lunch and recess, and also make sure the kids didn't kill each other.

LOUIS: *(heavy sigh and begins to pick up the trash)*

NARRATOR: [You see,] he loved all the children at Wayside School. He didn't want them playing on a dirty playground. As he was picking up the pencils and pieces of paper, a large truck drove into the parking lot. *(DOUBLE HONK . . . DOUBLE HONK)*

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INTRODUCTION

A Package for Mrs. Jewls from Wayside School is Falling Down by Louis Sachar

LOUIS: *(running out to the truck – he speaks in a loud whisper)* Quiet! Children are trying to learn in there! *(he points at the school)*

TRUCK DRIVER: *(stepping out of the truck)* I have a package for somebody named Mrs. Jewls.

LOUIS: I'll take it.

TRUCK DRIVER: Are you Mrs. Jewls? I have to give it to Mrs. Jewls.

NARRATOR: Louis thought a moment. He didn't want the man disturbing the children. He knew how much they hated to be interrupted when they were working.

LOUIS: *(in a falsetto voice)* I'm Mrs. Jewls.

TRUCK DRIVER: But you just said you weren't Mrs. Jewls,

LOUIS: *(still falsetto)* I changed my mind.

NARRATOR: The man got the package out of the back of the truck and gave it to Louis.

TRUCK DRIVER: Here you go, Mrs. Jewls.

LOUIS: *(taking the package and grunting from the weight)* Uhh!

NARRATOR: It was a very heavy package. The word FRAGILE was printed on every side. He had to be careful not to drop it. The package was so big, Louis couldn't see where he was going. Fortunately, he knew the way to Mrs. Jewls's class by heart. It was straight up.

Wayside School was thirty stories high, with only one room on each story. Mrs. Jewls's class was at the very top. It was Louis's favorite class. He pushed through the door to the school, then started up the stairs. There was no elevator. There were stairs that led down to the basement too, but nobody ever went down there. There were dead rats living in the basement.

LOUIS: *(huffing and puffing he makes hilarious faces)*

NARRATOR: The box was pressed against Louis's face, squashing his nose. Even so, when he reached the fifteenth floor, he could smell Miss Mush cooking in the cafeteria. It smelled like she was making mushrooms.

LOUIS: *(sniffing loudly he speaks aloud to himself)* Maybe on my way back I'll stop by Miss Mush's room and get some mushrooms! *(he continues up the stairs, groaning and huffing)*

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NARRATOR: He didn't want to miss Miss Mush's mushrooms. They were her specialty. His arms and legs were very sore, but he didn't want to rest.

LOUIS: *(speaking to himself)* This package might be important. I have to get it to Mrs. Jewls right away.

NARRATOR: He stepped easily from the eighteenth story to the twentieth. There was no nineteenth story. Miss Zarves taught the class on the nineteenth story. There was no Miss Zarves. At last, he struggled up the final step to the thirtieth story.

LOUIS: *(knocks on the door with his head)*

NARRATOR: Mrs. Jewls was in the middle of teaching her class about gravity when she heard the knock.

MRS. JEWLS: Come in!

LOUIS: *(gasping)* I can't open the door. My hands are full. I have a package for you.

MRS. JEWLS: *(to her class)* Who wants to open the door for Louis?

NARRATOR: All the children raised their hands. They loved to be interrupted when they were working.

MRS. JEWLS: Oh dear, how shall I choose? *(thinking)* I have to be fair about this. I know! We'll have a spelling bee. And the winner will get to open the door.

LOUIS: *(knocking his head against the door again and complaining)* It's heavy. And I'm very tired.

MRS. JEWLS: Just a second! Allison, the first word's for you. Heavy.

ALLISON: Heavy. H-E-A-V-Y. Heavy.

MRS. JEWLS: Very good. Jason, you're next. Tired.

JASON: Tired. S-L-E-E-P-Y. Tired.

LOUIS: *(trying to readjust the package, but not having much luck)*

NARRATOR: Louis felt the package slipping from his sweaty fingers. He shifted his weight to get a better grip. The corners of the box dug into the sides of his arms. He felt his hands go numb. Actually, he didn't feel them go numb.

MRS. JEWLS: Jenny, package.

JENNY: Package. B-O-X. Package.

MRS. JEWLS: Excellent!

NARRATOR: Louis felt like he was going to faint. At last John opened the door.

JOHN: I won the spelling bee, Louis!

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LOUIS: *(muttering)* Very good, John.

JOHN: Aren't you going to shake my hand?

LOUIS: *(shifts the box to one arm, he quickly shakes John's hand, grabs the box again and staggers into the room)* Where do you want it, Mrs. Jewls?

MRS. JEWLS: I don't know. What is it?

LOUIS: *(in obvious distress and losing patience)* I don't know. I'll have to put it down someplace so you can open it.

MRS. JEWLS: But how can I tell you where to put it until I know what it is? You might put it in the wrong place.

NARRATOR: So Louis held the box as Mrs. Jewls stood on a chair next to him and tore open the top. His legs wobbled beneath him.

MRS. JEWLS: It's a computer!

CHILDREN: *(booing)*

LOUIS: What's the matter? I thought everyone loved computers.

ERIC: We don't want it, Louis.

TERRENCE: Take it back, Jack.

MAURECIA: Get that piece of junk out of here.

R EDUCATIONAL

MRS. JEWLS: Now, don't be that way. The computer will help us learn. It's a lot quicker than a pencil and paper.

TODD: *(complaining)* But the quicker we learn, the more work we have to do

MRS. JEWLS: You may set it over there on the counter, Louis.

LOUIS: *(sets the computer on the counter and collapses)*

MRS. JEWLS: Now watch closely.

NARRATOR: Everyone gathered around the new computer. It had a full-color monitor and two disk drives.

MRS. JEWLS: *(huffs and puffs and pushes it out the open window!)*

NARRATOR: They all watched it fall and smash against the sidewalk.

LOUIS: *(slaps his forehead with a shocked and angry expression)*

CHILDREN: *(cheer)*

MRS. JEWLS: See? That's gravity.

JOE: Oh, now I get it!

MRS. JEWLS: Thank you, Louis. I've been trying to teach them about gravity all morning. We had been using pencils and pieces of paper, but the computer was a lot quicker.

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LOUIS: ARGHHHHHH!!

SOURCE INFORMATION

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